C-C-302C
February 8, 1971

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. C-C-00302B(Army-GL)
October 7, 1969 and
Fed. Spec. C-C-302A
March 25, 1960

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHEESE, SWISS, NATURAL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for natural Swiss cheese for use of all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Natural Swiss cheese covered by this specification shall be of the grades and styles as specified (see 3.3, 3.4 and 6.1).

1.2.2 Grades. The Swiss cheese shall conform to the requirements of the following grades, as specified (see 3.3):

U. S. Grade A
U. S. Grade B

1.2.3 Styles. The Swiss cheese shall be of the following styles and approximate weights, as specified (see 6.1):

(a) Wheels or drums - 160-225 pounds
(b) Rindless block - 10-100 pounds
(c) Cuts, sandwich - 5-15 pounds

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

FSC 8910

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Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1162	-	Sanitary Standards for Cheese and Cheese Products Plants

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

Directory of Consumer Protection Programs, Stations, Circuits and Officials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Grades of Swiss Cheese

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Dairy Division, Consumer and Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, D. C. 20250.)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D. C. 20044.)

American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1790 Broadway, New York, N. Y. 10019.)

The United States Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc.

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., 46 Park Avenue, New York, N. Y. 10016.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Milk. Raw milk shall be obtained from cows in herds accredited as tuberculosis-free and certified brucellosis-free by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (U.S.D.A.) or herds that have passed an annual tuberculosis test and meet U.S.D.A. requirements for an individually certified herd, or from cows in herds located in (1) a modified Accredited Tuberculosis Area; and (2) either (a) a Certified Brucellosis-free Area, or (b) a modified Certified Brucellosis Area; or (3) an area in the process of being accredited or certified by the U.S.D.A. In addition, the milk shall be normal in appearance; practically free from colostrum and have a clean sweet odor. It shall be subject to inspection by the procuring agency or duly authorized representative. The milk shall comply with the bacterial and sediment requirements of "General Specification for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service".

3.1.2 Salt. The salt shall be crystalline, free flowing sodium chloride of food grade quality. Iodized salt shall not be used.

3.1.3 Calcium chloride. Calcium chloride, when used, shall be of the purified form (U.S.P. grade).

3.1.4 Mold inhibiting agents. Mold inhibiting agents such as sorbic acid, potassium sorbate or sodium sorbate may be used on slices or cuts in consumer-sized packages. The amount used shall not exceed 0.3 percent by weight, calculated as sorbic acid.

3.2 Preparation. Swiss cheese shall be prepared by the Swiss method or any other procedure which produces a finished product meeting the requirements for Swiss (Emmentaler) cheese listed in the Definitions and Standards for Cheeses and Cheese Products under the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.3 The interpretation of the requirements (descriptive terms), for grades of natural Swiss cheese shall be as defined in the United States Standards for Grades

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of Swiss cheese. The natural Swiss cheese shall conform to the requirements of U.S. Grade A or B, as specified (see 6.1). The cheese shall contain not more than 41 percent moisture and in the water-free substance not less than 43 percent milk fat.

3.3.1 Style (a), Wheels or drums. Wheels or drums shall meet all the requirements specified in 3.3.

3.3.2 Style (b), Rindless block. Rindless block shall meet the requirements specified in 3.3 except for finish and appearance. At the time of delivery, the rindless block shall be rectangular in shape, substantially free from the rind as produced on wheels and blocks made by the conventional Emmentaler process, and substantially free of mold and other surface conditions which detract from utilization of the entire cheese.

3.3.3 Style (c), Cuts, sandwich. Rectangular cuts made from wheels or rindless blocks shall meet the requirements as specified in 3.3.1 and 3.3.2, respectively. The cuts shall be properly wrapped in a satisfactory wrapper or covering that will not impart any color or objectionable odor or flavor to the cheese. The wrapper shall completely envelop the cheese and protect it from damage during handling and transportation. All cut pieces shall be free from dry rind and other surface defects which detract from utilization of the entire piece.

3.4 All cheese shall be not less than 90 days old when graded.

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.6 Plant qualification.

3.6.1 For civil agencies. The processing plant, grounds, equipment, packaging materials, personnel practices and sanitary practices used in the production of this item, shall be such as to minimize the possibility of contamination of the product through microbial growth, dust, pests, rodents, condensate, or other unsanitary sources. The product shall be prepared and processed with minimum delay between the various stages of production.

3.6.2 For military agencies. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-1162 or in plants which operate under USDA Regulations Governing Grading and Inspection of Manufactured or Processed Dairy Products of the Code of Federal Regulations and listed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture in the document entitled "Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service" and approved for the finished product described in this specification.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 General. Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 Factory inspection. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the supplier of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 Final inspection. Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.2).

4.2.4 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the Military, see 4.2.9).

4.2.5 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Agriculture certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required in the contract or order.

4.2.5.1 Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.6 Plant qualification conditions.

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4.2.6.1 Civil and Military agencies. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.6.

4.2.7 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be made in accordance with provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated herein.

4.2.8 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.2.5, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.8.1 Inspection of milk and milk products.

4.2.8.1.1 Animal sources. Inspection shall be made to determine that cows supplying the milk used in the preparation of this product are in herds designated by the U.S. Department of Agriculture as tuberculosis-free and from herds designated brucellosis-free or in the process of being so designated. Determination of herd status regarding tuberculosis and brucellosis shall be made contacting the nearest office of the Agricultural Research Service of the Animal Health Division. (Location of this office can be ascertained by consulting the publication entitled "Directory of Consumer Protection Programs, Establishments, Circuits and Officials".) Nonconformance to either of the above requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.8.1.2 Establishment sources. Examination shall be made to determine that all processed milk products have been manufactured, packaged and shipped by establishments approved as Military sources of supply as listed in the Directory of Sanitarily approved Food Establishments for Armed Forces Procurement, or listed by the U. S. Department of Agriculture in the document entitled "Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service" and approved for the component products used to manufacture the finished product described in this specification. Nonconformance to either of the above requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot or of the involved quantity of finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.2.8.2 Examination of raw whole milk. Examination and testing of raw whole milk shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.1 as concerns appearance and odor, bacterial estimate and sediment at the approximate time of use. Records of all required examinations and

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tests shall be maintained and made available for review. Failure to comply with one or more of the above referenced requirement(s), reflected by actual examination and tests or by examination of records, shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of finished product.

4.2.8.3 Examination of salt, calcium chloride and mold inhibiting agents. Examination of these ingredients shall be in accordance with 4.2.8.3.1 and 4.2.8.3.2. Noncompliance with identity requirements or one or more sample units not complying with condition requirements of salt shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.2.8.3.1 Identity. Compliance of ingredients with the identity requirements of 3.1.2, 3.1.3, and 3.1.4 (kind and USP grade) shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent labels, invoices or other valid documents.

4.2.8.3.2 Condition. Salt shall be examined to determine compliance with the free flowing characteristic as specified in 3.1.2. The sample unit for examination shall be approximately 8 ounces derived from a primary container. The sample size shall be five. In the event a lot consists of less than 5 containers, a sample unit shall be taken from each container in the lot.

4.2.9 Examination of end item.

4.2.9.1 Examination of primary container. Examination of the primary container for condition and labeling shall be in accordance with the criteria in the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.2.9.2 Examination for net weight of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one filled shipping container. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the sample unit. Sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-4. The lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is determined to be less than the sample average marked net weight. In addition, the containers shall not be acceptable if the marked net weight exceeds the maximum specified. (NOTE: In determination of net weight when product is delivered in the intact package (plastic wrapper or bag) in which cured, such packaging will not be considered part of the tare weight. The net weight shall be expressed to the nearest 1/4 pound.)

4.2.9.3 Examination for finish and appearance of cheese (styles b and c) and age at time of grading (all styles). In addition to the inspection for

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the presence of the U. S. Department of Agriculture inspection and grading certificate, examination shall be made to determine compliance with the finish, appearance and age requirements of 3.3.2, 3.3.3 and 3.4, as applicable. Records of dates of manufacture and grading shall be maintained. Noncompliance with one or more of the aforementioned referenced requirements or missing date and grading records shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.2.9.4 Examination of filled and sealed shipping containers. Examination of the filled and sealed shipping containers for level B packing shall be in accordance with the examination criteria contained in the appendix to PPP-B-636 with the following addition to the table for examination: Major - Marking missing, incorrect or illegible. When applicable, shipping containers reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape shall not be acceptable.

4.2.10 Sampling procedure and acceptance criteria for testing of the finished product. The finished product shall be tested for the analytical characteristics specified in 3.3. Procedures for testing for fat and moisture shall be in accordance with 4.3. Test requirements shall be lot average requirements. The sample for testing shall be an approximate 1/2-pound composite of standard trier plugs of cheese derived from the number of primary containers indicated by inspection level S-2. The sample container shall be almost flush full to minimize evaporation or condensation until the cheese is tested. Lot size shall be expressed in pounds. Results shall be reported to the nearest one percent. The lot shall be rejected if one or more test results indicate noncompliance with the requirements.

4.3 Test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.3.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses when required, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter; Dairy Products, Section; Cheese.

Test	Method
Moisture	Moisture Method I
Fat	Fat

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4.3.2 Sediment and microbiological analyses. Sediment and microbiological analyses shall be performed in accordance with the following methods from Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products:

Test	Chapter	Method
Standard plate count	Agar Plate Method	Agar Plate
Direct Microscopic clump count	Direct Microscopic Method	Direct Microscopic clump count
Methylene Blue Reduction	Reduction Methods	Methylene Blue Reduction
Resazurin Reduction	Reduction Methods	Resazurin Reduction Method
Sediment	Sediment in Fluid Milk	General Methods

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B, styles (b) and (c). The Swiss cheese shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2, as applicable.

5.1.1.1 Rindless block, style (b). A 10 to 100 pound rindless block of Swiss cheese shall be packaged in a plastic wrapper or bag which shall protect the cheese during shipment, storage, and redistribution. The packaging material used shall impart no objectionable flavor, odor, or color to the cheese. The material shall envelop the cheese securely, conform closely to its shape, be unbroken, be practically free of wrinkles, and protect the surface fully. The cheese shall be delivered in the original wrapper or bag in which it was cured.

5.1.1.2 Sandwich cuts, style (c). Five to 15 pounds of sandwich cuts of Swiss cheese shall be packaged in a plastic bag meeting the requirements of 5.1.1.1. The bag shall be completely sealed.

5.1.2 Level C.

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5.1.2.1 Style (a). Wax dipping of wheels or drums is permissible but not required. If wax dipped, the coating shall be a continuous, unbroken and uniform film adhering tightly to the entire surface of the cheese.

5.1.2.2 Style (b) or (c). Swiss cheese shall be packaged in a manner to protect it from deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. The product packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B.

5.2.1.1 Style (b), rindless block. Not more than 100 pounds of the product packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed into a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container, constructed and closed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, V3s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 Style (c), cuts, sandwich (see 6.3 for precautionary information). Not more than 60 pounds of the product packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed into a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, V3s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.3 When specified (see 6.1 and 6.5), the shipping container specified in 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level C, (all styles). The product packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Unit containers. Commercial labeling meeting the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder will be acceptable.

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5.3.1.1.1 Each cheese other than cuts (style (c)) shall be identified with the following information on the cheese or wrapper by suitable marking or labeling.

Name of product
State where manufactured
Factory number
Vat number
Date of manufacture

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 and in addition shall include the following:

Number of units packed and total net weight of each container
Factory number (not required for sandwich cuts, style (c))
Vat number (not required for sandwich cuts, style (c))
Inspection mark (to be affixed by inspector)

5.3.1.2.1 Additional marking. The following information as applicable shall be printed or legibly stenciled in letters not less than 1 inch high on top of the shipping container:

PERISHABLE--KEEP REFRIGERATED
SPACE BOXES FOR VENTILATION

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Unit containers. Labeling as specified in 5.3.1.1 will be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and as specified in 5.3.2.2.1, except that the date of pack will be the date of manufacture and net weight shall be expressed to the nearest 1/4-pound.

5.3.2.2.1 Additional marking. The following information, as applicable shall be printed or legibly stenciled in letters not less than 1 inch high on top of the shipping container:

PERISHABLE--KEEP REFRIGERATED
SPACE BOXES FOR VENTILATION

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred option permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Grade, style and weight of cheese required (see 1.2.2 and 1.2.3).
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Whether requirements of U.S. Grade A or B are required (see 3.3).
(d) When an official inspection certificate for grade of product is to be furnished (see 4.2.5).
(e) When packing specified in 5.2.1.3 is required.

6.2 Destination inspection (for civil agencies). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only. Unless otherwise specified, such inspection should be made by the receiving facility.

6.3 Technical information concerning style (c) packaged product. Cuts (regardless of shape or size) derived from wheels or blocks of natural cheese are subject to mold and yeast growth to a greater degree than on the wheels or blocks cured within the original sack. To minimize appearance of such undesirable growth, considerable care must be taken during the cutting and wrapping of the cheese to avoid contamination, and the packaged cheese must be kept under refrigeration to minimize rate of appearance of surface spoilage on the cheese. Maintenance of low relative humidity during the packaging operation should minimize the condition necessary for growth of surface spoilage organisms. Commercial practice for use of this style packaging of cheese is to move the product to the consumer within a period of three months after packaging with good control concerning storage during this period. Style (c) product with date of pack greater than three months should always be used first. Frequent inspection should be made to determine that surface spoilage has not started.

6.4 Military agencies. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipping, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15.

6.5 Packing specified in 5.2.1.3 is intended for transfer at sea operations or specific Navy overseas operations.

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MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
Air Force - 03
DSA - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCIES INTEREST:

GSA
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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION Cheese, Swiss, Natural C-C-302C

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

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REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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